Abdul Majid went up to the first floor of the house escorted by a soldier and took out his AK-47 alongwith four fully loaded magazines. These had been cleverly concealed in the attic. Giving them to the major, he said, 'Sahib, this is all I have. Though I had gone across the border for being trained for jehad, khuda kasam, I have never taken part in any action against the security forces. I have never used this gun! I am innocent – I swear by Allah.'

'Do you know the way to Shera village through the forest,' asked Ravi.

'Yes, sir', replied Abdul Majid.

'Okay, then come with us, and quickly guide us to that place.'

He couldn't be late and delay the mission of the entire battalion. He had to make up for the lost time. Grabbing Abdul Majid by the arm, he led him out of the house.

'Don't take him away, he is innocent. Have you forgotten your promise, Major Sahib?' begged the old woman.

'Ammi, I am a man of my word, and take pride in this uniform that I am wearing. Your son will not be harmed. We in the army are responsible and humane. I am sure he shall be forgiven for taking up arms against the state, provided he promises to mend his ways. Also, for the sake of this bride of a few days, he is not going to be sent behind bars! He will be back by the evening', assured Ravi. Before leaving the house, Ravi asked the accompanying policeman to take an all-clear certificate from the two women so that there would be no scope for false allegations later on. When I was informed of this incident, I ordered that the gun should be confiscated and the young man be let off with a stern warning. This action brought us a lot of praise and the goodwill of the people.

In another action during the month of February, I was accompanied by the GOC, Major General Inder Varma. We walked in the snow the whole night and cordoned off two villages with one battalion each. One of these was Khaitangan. The next morning nothing happened till about 9 a.m. So the GOC decided to go back to his HQ. He must have barely reached when one of my battalions hit a gold mine.